

Part II — The Editorial Domain Model

1. Purpose

The Editorial Domain Model defines the knowledge entities governed by the Wardle Editorial Operating System (WEOS).

These entities are not implementation objects, database tables, or software components. They are editorial concepts that represent how clinical knowledge is created, evaluated, maintained, and published.

Every capability within WEOS operates upon one or more of these entities.

The domain model establishes:

- what exists within the editorial system
- why it exists
- how entities relate to one another
- how knowledge progresses through editorial governance
- where editorial decisions occur

All future implementations should preserve these concepts regardless of the underlying technology.

2. Editorial Philosophy of the Domain

Medical knowledge is not published as isolated documents.

Instead, it exists as an interconnected network of educational artifacts that collectively teach diagnostic reasoning.

A diagnosis is not merely accompanied by a case.

It is explained through objectives.

It is reinforced through teaching rules.

It is clarified through clinical pearls.

It is distinguished through differential diagnoses.

It is connected through knowledge relationships.

It is evaluated through evidence.

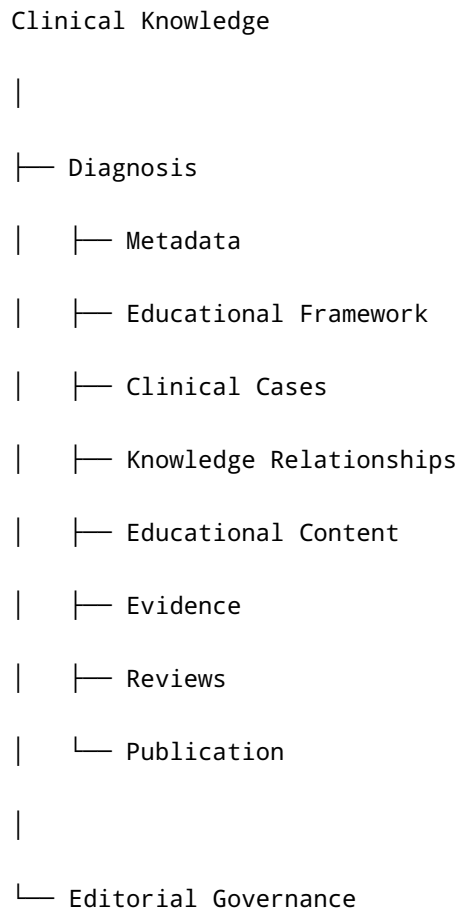
It is continuously improved through editorial review.

WEOS therefore models editorial knowledge as an ecosystem rather than a hierarchy of documents.

3. Editorial Artifact Hierarchy

The editorial system governs a collection of related artifacts.

These artifacts exist at different levels of abstraction.



The Diagnosis is the primary unit of editorial governance.

All other artifacts either describe, teach, validate, or govern the diagnosis.

4. Primary Editorial Entities

4.1 Diagnosis

The Diagnosis is the central knowledge entity within WEOS.

Every editorial activity ultimately contributes to improving one or more diagnoses.

A diagnosis defines the educational identity around which all associated knowledge is organised.

A diagnosis is responsible for:

- clinical identity
- taxonomy
- metadata
- educational scope
- publication status
- knowledge relationships
- associated educational artifacts

A diagnosis is never considered "finished."

It continuously evolves throughout its editorial lifetime.

4.2 Clinical Case

Clinical cases are educational expressions of a diagnosis.

Their purpose is not to document patient encounters but to teach diagnostic reasoning.

A case should progressively guide learners toward a diagnosis while reinforcing important discriminators, avoiding premature diagnostic disclosure, and supporting educational objectives.

Cases exist to teach.

They are not the diagnosis itself.

Multiple cases may exist for the same diagnosis.

Different cases may target different learner levels, clinical settings, or reasoning challenges while contributing to the same body of governed knowledge.

4.3 Educational Framework

Every diagnosis possesses an educational framework that defines what learners should understand after studying the diagnosis.

The educational framework includes:

- teaching objectives
- teaching rules
- clinical pearls
- clinical pitfalls
- recall prompts
- key concepts
- educational priorities

This framework defines the educational intent of the diagnosis before individual cases are written.

Cases should reinforce the educational framework rather than create it.

4.4 Diagnostic Knowledge Relationships

Clinical knowledge does not exist independently.

Diagnoses relate to one another through clinically meaningful relationships.

Examples include:

- differential diagnoses
- diagnostic mimics
- discriminating features
- supporting relationships
- prerequisite concepts
- shared mechanisms
- complication relationships

These relationships collectively form the diagnostic knowledge graph.

The knowledge graph is an editorial artifact requiring continuous governance rather than an automatically generated structure.

4.5 Educational Content

Educational content explains the diagnosis outside the context of gameplay.

It transforms diagnostic reasoning into structured learning.

Examples include:

- clinical summaries
- diagnostic reasoning explanations
- investigation guidance
- management principles
- examination findings
- pathophysiology
- complications
- references

Educational content should remain consistent with both clinical evidence and the educational framework.

4.6 Evidence

Evidence supports editorial confidence.

Evidence does not exist merely to satisfy citation requirements.

Its purpose is to justify educational decisions.

Evidence may support:

- clinical statements
- diagnostic relationships
- teaching rules
- management recommendations
- investigation guidance
- educational claims

The absence of supporting evidence does not necessarily imply incorrectness but always reduces editorial confidence.

4.7 Editorial Review

Editorial review transforms authored content into governed knowledge.

Review is a continuous process rather than a single approval event.

Editorial review evaluates:

- clinical correctness

- educational quality
- reasoning integrity
- internal consistency
- evidence sufficiency
- learner impact

Every review produces explicit editorial decisions that contribute to the governance history of an artifact.

4.8 Publication

Publication represents institutional confidence in an editorial artifact.

Publication is not merely a visibility state.

It signifies that the artifact has satisfied the required editorial standards for learner exposure.

Published knowledge remains subject to future review, improvement, and retirement.

5. Relationships Between Entities

The domain model intentionally separates educational concepts while recognising that they influence one another.

Examples include:

- Cases teach Diagnoses.
- Objectives define what Cases should teach.
- Teaching Rules reinforce Objectives.
- Clinical Pearls enrich understanding of Diagnoses.
- Differential Relationships distinguish Diagnoses.
- Evidence supports Educational Content.
- Reviews govern every artifact.
- Publication exposes governed knowledge to learners.

No artifact exists independently.

Every editorial artifact contributes to a larger network of diagnostic understanding.

6. Editorial Dependencies

Certain editorial entities depend upon others before meaningful work can begin.

For example:

A diagnosis requires metadata before educational generation.

Educational objectives should exist before comprehensive case authoring.

Teaching rules should exist before evaluating educational coverage.

Knowledge relationships should inform differential reasoning.

Cases should reinforce established educational intent.

Publication depends upon satisfactory governance of all required artifacts.

These dependencies define the logical progression of editorial work while remaining flexible enough to support iterative refinement.

7. Editorial Identity

Every editorial artifact possesses an independent identity.

An artifact may evolve through multiple revisions while remaining the same conceptual entity.

For example:

A clinical pearl may undergo numerous revisions.

A teaching objective may be rewritten.

A diagnostic relationship may gain stronger supporting evidence.

These changes improve the artifact without replacing its identity.

Editorial governance therefore focuses upon preserving the continuity of knowledge while allowing continuous refinement.

8. Artifact Independence

Editorial artifacts are intentionally modular.

A clinical pearl should not require rewriting a case.

Updating investigation guidance should not invalidate teaching objectives.

Improving a differential relationship should automatically strengthen future educational content without requiring manual duplication.

This modularity enables scalable editorial maintenance while preserving consistency throughout the knowledge ecosystem.

9. Domain Model Principles

The Editorial Domain Model is governed by the following principles.

Every diagnosis is the centre of a governed body of knowledge.

Cases are educational expressions rather than isolated documents.

Educational intent precedes educational delivery.

Knowledge relationships are first-class editorial artifacts.

Evidence strengthens editorial confidence.

Review governs all knowledge.

Publication represents institutional trust.

Knowledge remains continuously evolvable throughout its lifetime.

These principles define the conceptual structure upon which every subsequent component of the Wardle Editorial Operating System is built.

Closing Principle

The Editorial Domain Model describes what WEOS governs.

Subsequent sections describe how that knowledge is created, reviewed, improved, and entrusted to learners.